

Sotiris Iliadis

Product Designer & Design Engineer · Accessible, Accountable AI

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Dear Poolside team,

When a model writes the code, the hard interface problem isn't showing the output - it's showing the developer why to trust it, and where they still hold the pen. An AI that ships real work lives or dies on whether an engineer can see what it did, follow the reasoning, and keep the final call without fighting the tool for it. That's not a property of the model. It's a property of the surface - and it's design engineering, made in real code, not handed off as a screen.

That seam is where I work. I'm a designer with 13 years of craft who builds in code - React, Tailwind, Astro - and takes an idea to a working, accessible interface myself. The clearest proof is the Article 50 UI Pattern Kit: an open-source (MIT) React component library I designed and built for EU AI Act transparency, four WCAG 2.1 AA components with a passing axe audit, on GitHub with a live demo (github.com/sotosili/article50-kit). Its core is exactly your problem in miniature - an AI that streams its reasoning, shows a real confidence signal, and hands the decision to a human when it's unsure: approve, override, or reject. The machine decides; a person still answers for it. That accountable loop is the whole point of a tool developers are meant to trust with production work.

Poolside is building the surface where that trust gets won or lost - and treating the people who build it as engineers, not decorators. That's the environment I do my best work in: craft, code, and a real point of view about keeping a human in the loop. I'd love to bring it to the interface your developers touch first. I would love to talk.

Best regards,

Sotiris Iliadis

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